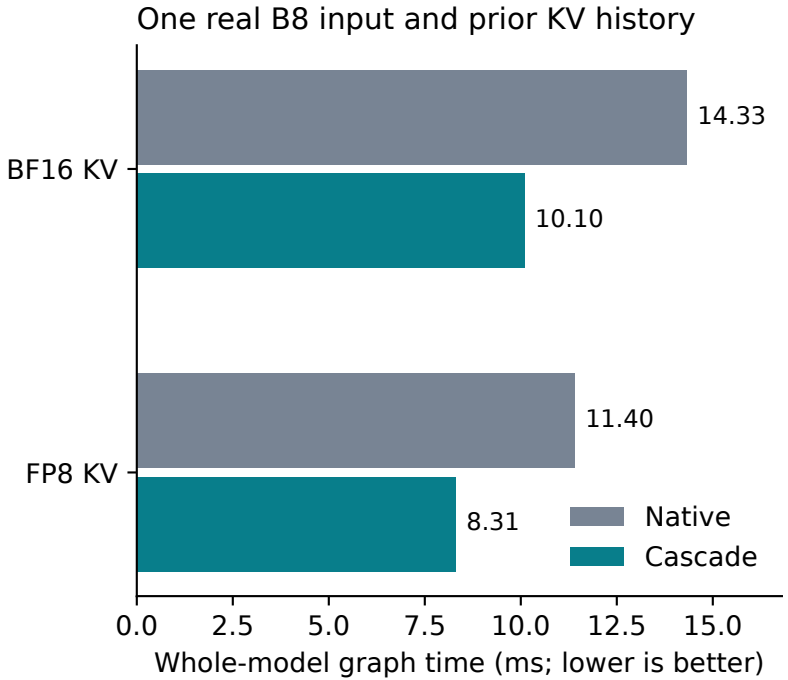

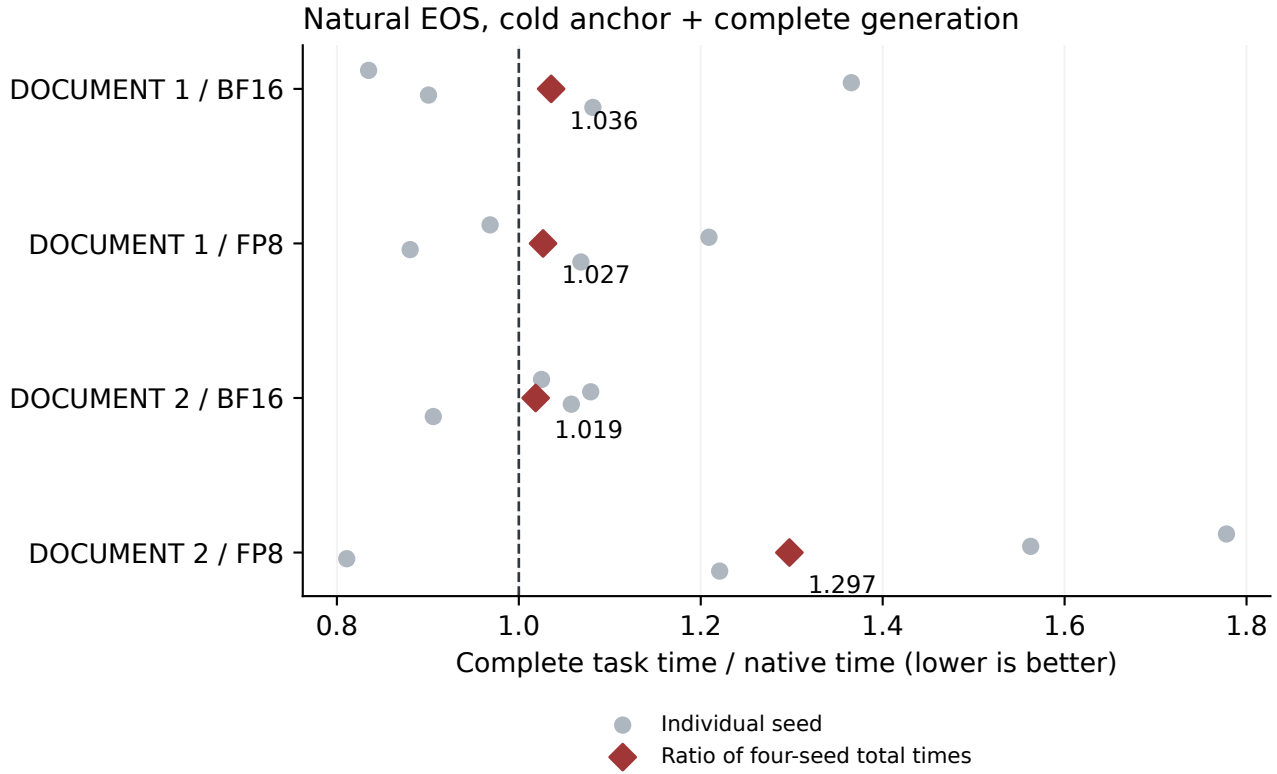

Left excludes per-step host preparation and prefill. Right retains all output lengths and quality outcomes; 2 documents, 4 seeds, no capped answers.
These measure different boundaries. Existing cascade is a control, not a new contribution; task quality non-inferiority is not established.